

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure and Microsoft 365 Security | Cloud Security Architecture | PowerShell Automation

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, implementing, and managing security measures for Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments at enterprise scale. I have a strong track record of operationalising cloud security architecture across hybrid infrastructure, applying security-as-code practices through PowerShell scripting and automation, and aligning controls to established frameworks including the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, and ISO 27001. I have hands-on experience with Microsoft Entra Identity (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM). I combine strong analytical and problem-solving skills with the ability to communicate complex security concepts clearly to both technical and non-technical stakeholders, and I hold relevant Microsoft and industry security certifications including CISSP and the Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA).

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Azure and Microsoft 365 Security:** Microsoft Entra Identity (Azure Active Directory), Azure security controls, Conditional Access, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender suite, Defender XDR (Extended Detection and Response)
- **Cloud Security Architecture:** Azure security design and implementation; hybrid cloud and on-premise security integration; Zero Trust architecture; Microsoft Entra Conditional Access; security-as-code methodology
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for security automation; Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development; workflow automation aligned with CI/CD principles; Azure Logic Apps-equivalent automation design
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity; Conditional Access policy design; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO); BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); role-based access control (RBAC)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM); CrowdStrike Falcon EDR; Tanium; endpoint hardening and compliance policy management
- **Security Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK framework; security risk assessment and management
- **SIEM and Monitoring:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management) with KQL (Kusto Query Language); CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM; Splunk (SPL); log data analysis and security monitoring
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); AppCheck; Nessus; exposure management across cloud and on-premise estates

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Design, implement, and manage security measures for Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments across a hybrid enterprise estate, applying security-as-code principles and PowerShell scripting to automate control deployment and monitoring.
- Architect and maintain Conditional Access policies within Microsoft Entra Identity (Azure Active Directory), enforcing risk-based Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO) across the enterprise in line with Zero Trust architecture principles.
- Administer Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance policies across managed and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) endpoints within the M365 estate.

- Engineer detection and response capabilities in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), developing high-fidelity detection rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and reducing false positive rates through continuous tuning.
- Lead security operations across Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Defender for Identity (MDI) for over 8,000 users, driving integrated Extended Detection and Response (XDR) coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud workloads.
- Design and deploy Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell and Logic Apps-aligned automation workflows, reducing analyst manual workload and standardising incident response procedures.
- Manage exposure across cloud, on-premise, and third-party estates through a structured vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and AppCheck, with end-to-end remediation tracking.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access controls across critical Azure and on-premise systems, supporting audit readiness and compliance with CIS Controls and ISO 27001.
- Contribute to security architecture reviews, cloud security assessments, and third-party risk evaluations, aligning recommendations with the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Lead Cyber Essentials Plus certification, overseeing control evidence gathering and remediation across network security, access control, patching, and malware protection domains.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Supported design and implementation of Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra Identity) Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) controls to secure access to M365 and cloud-based applications.
- Contributed to the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment, assisting with policy configuration, exclusion management, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for centralised Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) correlation.
- Wrote and refined Microsoft Sentinel KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection rules and alert logic, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, as part of continuous detection engineering improvement cycles.
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, ensuring compliance of the device estate with organisational security standards.
- Supported vulnerability management activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, tracking remediation of identified vulnerabilities across Azure cloud and on-premise infrastructure.
- Contributed to security automation initiatives using PowerShell scripting, including automated alert enrichment, compliance reporting, and account lifecycle management tasks.
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities, assisting with control evidence collection, risk registers, and gap analysis documentation.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed Azure Active Directory identity and access management for a cloud-first Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, administering role-based access control (RBAC), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and user provisioning.
- Maintained Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) configuration and Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) policy enforcement across the device estate.
- Developed and maintained PowerShell scripts for identity management, compliance reporting, and security configuration automation across Azure cloud infrastructure.
- Supported endpoint security configuration, patch management, and network security controls, ensuring compliance with ISO 27001 principles and internal security standards.
- Contributed to IT security quality reviews, supporting internal audit preparation and producing evidence documentation for information security controls.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed Microsoft Entra Identity (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) architecture for an 8,000+ user enterprise, significantly reducing identity-related risk exposure and enabling Zero Trust access controls.
- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across the full enterprise estate, delivering integrated XDR (Extended Detection and Response) coverage for cloud and hybrid workloads.
- Engineered Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection content in KQL (Kusto Query Language) mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates.
- Built Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation workflows using PowerShell and Logic Apps-aligned design patterns, standardising incident response and reducing analyst toil across the security operations function.
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating compliance of the organisation's Azure and on-premise estate against the UK National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) framework requirements.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across critical Azure and on-premise systems, enforcing least-privilege access and supporting alignment with CIS Controls and ISO 27001 access management requirements.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)